

DEMO DAY · 21 SEPTEMBER 2026

The whole thing, word for word

What to say before you touch the laptop, every click in order, what to say while you click it, how to close, and a quiz to test yourself on the way in.

Vertex ERP — Enterprise Resource Planning
and Workflow Management System

Shahjalal Islami Bank PLC — Common Services Division

What you are actually showing them

The bank needs 12 laptops. Around ₳ 14 lakh. That is too much money for someone to just go and buy, so by law they must let several companies compete for the work. That competition is a **tender**. Each company sends in an offer. An offer is a **bid**.

Why every bid comes in two sealed envelopes

The oldest trick in procurement: somebody inside looks at the prices first, sees that his friend's company is expensive, and then invents a technical reason to knock out the cheaper ones. He picks the winner, then writes the justification backwards.

So each bidder sends **two separate sealed envelopes**. **Envelope 1 — Technical:** what am I selling you, what warranty, proof I am a real Dell dealer. No price anywhere. **Envelope 2 — Financial:** the price, and nothing else.

The bank opens **only the technical envelopes** first, judges every bidder on quality alone, and writes the decision down. Only then does anyone open the prices. Nobody can work backwards, because the order is locked.

The story you are telling

Three companies bid: **Rahim Traders, Meghna Technologies** and **Bengal Office Solutions**.

Bengal is the cheapest — ₳ 13,20,000. But Bengal did not enclose the authorised Dell distributor certificate, and offers one year carry-in warranty instead of three years onsite. For counter equipment in a bank, that fails.

So Bengal is thrown out **before anybody knows they were cheapest**. The winner is Rahim Traders at ₳ 13,86,000 — ₳ 66,000 more expensive. And the system can prove, with timestamps, that the rejection happened before any price was visible.

That single fact is the demo. Everything else is scaffolding around it.

READ THIS FIRST

The five people

WHO	WHAT THEY DO IN THE STORY
Rezaul Karim	Officer, Gulshan Branch. Asks for the laptops. Approves nothing.
Farhana Akter	Department Head. First approval. Also sits on the evaluation committee.
Shahidul Islam	Procurement. Runs the tender, writes the work order, receives the goods.
Tanvir Ahmed	Chairs the evaluation committee. Opens the envelopes, picks the winner.
Nasrin Sultana	Finance. Enters the bill.

Plus **Mizanur Rahman** for the second approval, and **Kamrun Nahar** & **Golam Mostafa** for the payment sign-off if you have time.

Before you walk in

```
npm run reset    # clean slate, about 5 seconds
npm run demo     # builds and serves on localhost:3000
npm run warm     # pre-loads every page so none of them stalls
```

The app runs entirely on your own laptop — it never calls out to the internet. Say that out loud during the demo. Do not offer to prove it by disconnecting: you are on a call, and you will disconnect yourself.

- Laptop on mains power. Screen sleep off. Notifications off. Do-not-disturb on.
- Browser at 100% zoom, one window, no other tabs. Share that window only, not the whole screen.
- Every password is **Demo@2026**.
- **Switch user** is in the top bar. It moves between people without retyping anything.
- Sign in as **rezaul.karim@sjiblb.com** and leave the dashboard on screen.

If you have never done this before

You are not there to perform. You are there to show them a thing that works and answer questions honestly. That is a much lower bar than the one in your head.

Five minutes before you join

- App already running, already signed in as **Rezaul Karim**, dashboard on screen. Never start a call on a login page.
- One browser window. No other tabs. No notifications.
- This document open beside you, or printed. Reading from it is fine. Nobody can tell.
- Glass of water within reach.
- Say your opening line out loud once, to yourself, before you join. Once is enough.

The three things that actually go wrong

Talking too fast. Everybody does it. Deliberately slow down on the first sentence of each section and the rest follows.

Filling silence. When something refuses, stop. Three seconds feels like a minute to you and like confidence to them.

Answering a question you do not know. “I don't know, I'll come back to you today” costs you nothing. A wrong answer costs you the contract.

You know more than they do about this system

You built it. They have read a proposal. That is the whole gap, and it is entirely in your favour. Behave accordingly.

Word for word

Read it as written the first time. Once you are two sentences in you will stop needing it.

“Good morning, and thank you for having us back.

I'm Jaiden Lau, for the joint venture — Yufence, Harvest Partners and Nascenia.
With me are name and name .

Before I open anything, I want to say what we think this project actually is.

PAUSE — TWO SECONDS

Right now, a purchase in Common Services starts on a piece of paper. It moves between desks. And if you asked this morning where a particular requisition had got to, somebody would have to go and find out.

That is not a technology problem. Almost every bank in this country runs that way. **The problem is that a process nobody can see is a process nobody can prove.**

So what we are going to show you is that same process — the one you already run — from start to finish, in one system, in about fifteen minutes. Nothing invented. Your requisition, your tender, your work order, your payment.

And I would ask you to watch for one thing in particular. Three times in the next fifteen minutes, I am going to try to do something I should not be allowed to do. And three times, the system is going to stop me. **Those three moments are what we actually built.**

name and name are here for the technical questions — hosting, architecture, how this connects to your core banking system. Please interrupt whenever you like. You do not have to wait until the end.

PAUSE — THEN

Shall I begin?”

Write the two names in by hand before you join, so you are not searching for them mid-sentence.

How to run the hour

WHEN THIS HAPPENS

DO THIS

Somebody interrupts

Good. Stop and take it. An interrupted demo is a demo somebody is watching. Answer it, then say “where was I — yes” and carry on.

A technical question

Hand it over **by name**. “ name , that one's yours.” Using the name forces them to speak and shows the bank you have a team.

You don't know

“I don't know. I'll come back to you on that today.” Then write it down where they can see you writing it down.

A money question

You answer it. Nobody else. Not scope, not price, not timeline commitments.

Somebody disagrees with your partner

Let it go in the room. Sort it out afterwards. Two vendors contradicting each other is the worst thing a bank can see.

A refusal lands and nobody speaks

Say nothing. Count to three. Then move on.

You lose your place

“Give me one second.” Find it. Nobody minds. Waffling while you look is what they mind.

The sentence to fall back on

If you are ever stuck, say this and then do it:

“Let me just show you.”

You are standing in front of a working system. That is an advantage almost nobody presenting to this bank will have. Use it instead of talking.

Somebody asks for something

1

You are already signed in as Rezaul Karim. Do not click anything yet. Point at the sidebar.

SAY "This is Rezaul. An officer at Gulshan Branch. He is the bottom of the ladder, and he is where every purchase in this bank actually starts."

Bottom left of the sidebar reads **7 of 27 areas visible to Requisition Initiator**. Point at it.

2

Say what he cannot see.

SAY "No approvals. No tenders. No finance. Nothing about money. The system already knows who he is, and it shows him his own work and nothing else."

3

Click **Requisitions** → **New requisition**

A requisition is just a request to buy something. Say that out loud once, early.

4

In Title type: **Laptop replacement for branch operations staff**

5

In the item search box type **laptop** **. Click Dell Latitude 5450 in the dropdown. A green panel opens.**

SAY "He has not typed a number yet, and it has already told him: three in stock, reorder level ten, and the bank last paid one lakh eighteen thousand five hundred each, in June."

6

Set Quantity to **15** **. Watch the small line that appears beside the button.**

SAY "He asked for fifteen. It found three already sitting in the store. So only twelve get bought. The bank does not buy what it already owns."

The line reads **3 from store, 12 to purchase**. That number 12 comes back twice more later.

7

Click **Add line** **. Scroll down, paste a justification, click**
Submit for approval

You land on **REQ/CSD/2026/0847**, total ₳ **17,77,500**.

He tries to approve it himself

8

Still as Rezaul, on his own requisition, press **Attempt approval**

SAY “Rezaul wants his laptops. So he tries to approve his own request.”

The screen goes red and refuses. “You raised this document, so you cannot approve it.”

9

Press **Why was this blocked?**

SAY “This is not a rule in a manual that somebody can decide to ignore. That refusal happened inside the database transaction that would have made the change. There is no way around it — not for him, not for me, not for your system administrator.”

Now stop talking. Let them look at it. This is the first of the five moments and it is the one that tells them you understood the brief.

Do not rush past this

Every bank in the room has been sold a system that says “maker-checker” in the brochure and then lets a branch manager approve his own indent because the button was there.

Three seconds of silence here is worth more than three minutes of features.

Then approve it properly

10

Switch user in the top bar → **Farhana Akter**. **Point at her sidebar.**

SAY “Farhana is his department head. Look at her sidebar — it is bigger than his. Same system, different person, different bank.”

11

My Approvals → press **Review & approve** on the 0847 row.

12

Look at the approval chain on the right. Step three is greyed out.

SAY “It routed itself through two levels because of the amount. A bigger request would go all the way to the Managing Director. And notice — it does not just skip him quietly. It tells you why.”

It reads: *Not required — value does not exceed the ₳ 20,00,000 threshold.*

13

Press **Approve. Then **Switch user** → **Mizanur Rahman** → **Approve****

SAY “Two people, two levels, and neither of them is the man who asked for it. Now it is approved.”

Now it goes out to tender

Say this before you click anything

“Approved does not mean bought. Fourteen lakh is too much to just go and spend, so it has to go out to competition. Several companies get told what we need, and each one sends in a sealed offer.”

“What I am about to open is the same kind of purchase, already a few weeks further along, so you can see the whole of it rather than the first step.”

14

Switch user → **Shahidul Islam**. Click **Tenders**. Open **TND/SJIBL/2026/112**.

SAY “Published eleven days ago. Closed yesterday. Three companies bid.”

Keep this fast. It is setup, not a highlight.

15

Optional, sixty seconds. New browser tab → **localhost:3000/vendor/login**
→ **sign in as** **bids@rahimtraders.com.bd**

SAY “This is what the supplier sees. Different look, different login, completely separate. A bidder cannot see who else has bid, how many have bid, or what anybody offered. They are not users of your bank — they are outside it.”

Cut this first if you are short of time. Close the tab and go back.

What happens next, in one sentence

Three bids are sitting in that tender. Each one is two sealed envelopes — **what they are selling**, and **what it costs**. The next four pages are the bank opening them in the right order, and the system refusing to let it happen in the wrong order.

You try to look at the prices

16

Switch user → **Tanvir Ahmed**. Open **TND/SJIBL/2026/112** → **Bids** tab.

SAY “Tanvir chairs the evaluation committee. Three bids. Look at each one — two boxes, one on top of the other.”

17

Point at the lower box on each bid. It is gold, cross-hatched, with a padlock, and shows ♣ ■■,■■,■■■

SAY “That is the price envelope. It is still sealed. There is an envelope reference next to it so you can prove later that nobody swapped it.”

18

Press **Open financial envelope**

Refused. “Financial offers for this tender are sealed.”

19

Press **Why was this blocked?**

SAY “Nobody can see those prices yet. Not me. Not the committee. Not your system administrator. And this is the part that matters — the amount is not fetched from the database and hidden on the screen. It is never fetched at all. The only piece of code in this system that can read a price refuses to run until technical evaluation is signed off.”

The panel names the **data access layer** and quotes **clause 1.9** of their own tender document back at them.

This is the control a bank cares about most

Let it sit. If you say one more sentence after “until technical evaluation is signed off,” you will talk them out of being impressed.

If somebody asks “what if the administrator changes it in the database?” — good, that is the right question, and you answer it on the audit trail screen at the end. Tell them you will come back to it. Then actually come back to it.

Judge them on quality, then look

- 20 Go to the **Evaluation** tab. Press **Open technical envelope** on all three bids.

SAY “So we open the other envelope instead. Not the price — what they are actually selling us.”

- 21 Scroll to **Bengal Office Solutions**. There is a checklist. One line is red.

SAY “Bengal did not enclose the authorised Dell distributor certificate. They sent a letter promising they would source them through a reseller. And they offer one year carry-in warranty instead of three years onsite. These machines sit on cash counters. That fails.”

The red line reads **Authorised distributor certificate from the manufacturer — NOT SUBMITTED**. The checklist is built from what each bidder actually attached, not typed in by hand.

- 22 Before you decide, point at the whole screen.

SAY “There is no price anywhere on this page. Not hidden, not greyed out — not here. So this decision cannot possibly be influenced by what anybody asked for.”

- 23 Press **Qualify** on Rahim Traders. **Qualify** on Meghna. **Disqualify** on Bengal.

You can leave the score and comment boxes empty — sensible defaults fill in. Type into them only if you want to.

- 24 Press the gold button: **Complete and unseal financials**

SAY “The committee has now signed off its findings. That is what lifts the seal — and it cannot be undone.”

- 25 Go back to the **Bids** tab. The gold boxes are open. Read the three numbers out.

Rahim ₳ **13,86,000** · Meghna ₳ **14,04,000** · Bengal ₳ **13,20,000**

Now say this, slowly

“The company we just threw out was the cheapest. And we did not know that when we threw them out. That is what the two envelopes are for.”

If you only land one sentence all day, land this one. Pause after it.

Put it on paper and pick the winner

26

Go to the **Overview** tab and press **Generate comparative statement**

SAY “This is the document your purchase committee actually signs. It ranks only the bidders who passed on quality.”

It opens on bank letterhead with a signature block. It is the paperwork the file needs, produced by the system rather than retyped by a junior.

27

Read the recommendation paragraph out loud.

SAY “And it says so in writing — that a cheaper offer existed, that it was rejected before any price was visible, and that under clause 1.10 of your own tender rules the bank is not obliged to accept the lowest offer. That is the paragraph your auditor wants and never gets.”

28

Optional. On Bengal's red row, press **Attempt award**

SAY “And just in case somebody tries anyway.”

Refused. A disqualified bidder cannot be awarded the contract whatever price they offered. Cut this if you are running long.

29

On Rahim Traders' row — rank 1 — press **Award**

SAY “Rahim Traders wins. Sixty-six thousand taka more expensive than the one we rejected, and every step of why is on the file.”

If somebody says “so you paid more”

They are testing you. The answer is short:

“Yes. Sixty-six thousand taka more, for three years of onsite warranty from the manufacturer instead of one year carry-in from a reseller. On twelve machines sitting on your cash counters. The point is not that we paid more — it is that nobody in this building could have engineered that outcome, in either direction.”

The order for twelve, not fifteen

30

Switch user → **Shahidul Islam.** **Purchase orders** → **New work order**

SAY “Rahim won, so now we write them the actual order. A work order. Notice it is already filled in — twelve units, Rahim Traders, at the price they quoted. Nobody retyped anything, so nobody can mistype anything.”

31

Change the quantity from 12 to 15. Press **Issue work order**

SAY “Now suppose somebody in procurement decides to round it up. Fifteen instead of twelve.”

Refused. *Approved quantity: 12. Attempted quantity: 15.*

32

Let them read the refusal, then say it.

SAY “Twelve were approved, back at the very start, because three were already in the store. So twelve is what can be bought. The work order is checked line by line against the original approval. Quantities cannot drift between the approval and the purchase — and that drift is where most procurement loss in the world actually happens.”

Tie it back: **that 12 came from the stock check on the very first screen**, forty minutes ago. Point out that it travelled all the way here on its own.

33

Change it back to 12. Press **Issue work order**

The work order prints on bank letterhead, with the amount written out in words.

Three refusals, and that is the pitch

You cannot approve your own request. You cannot see a price before you have judged the quality. You cannot buy fifteen when twelve were approved.

“You are not buying software that helps your people do their job. You have people who can do their job. You are buying software that will not let the wrong thing happen.”

PART EIGHT

It arrives, and it gets paid

Move faster now. This part proves the loop closes; it is not where the argument is won.

- 34** On the work order page press **Record receipt**. Enter a challan number, 12 received, 12 accepted. Press **Record receipt**.

SAY “The laptops arrive. The storekeeper counts them. If he had counted ten, the system would carry two as still outstanding and the bill would not match.”

The officer who raised the requisition — Rezaul — is notified automatically. Mention it, do not go and show it.

- 35** **Switch user** → **Nasrin Sultana** → **Invoices** → **Enter invoice**

SAY “Nasrin is in the bills section. The supplier's invoice has arrived.”

- 36** Point at the three-way match panel — three columns side by side, green where they agree.

SAY “The order, the delivery, and the bill. Side by side. If any of those three disagree on the item, the quantity or the price, the bill cannot even be sent for approval. It does not get routed, it gets stopped.”

- 37** Scroll to the money below it.

SAY “VAT, income tax deducted at source, and five percent security money held back through the warranty period. That is clause 1.15 of your own tender document, calculated rather than remembered.”

- 38** Press **Enter invoice and run match**

- 39** If you have time. **Switch user** → **Sumaiya Haque** → **Approve**. Then **Kamrun Nahar** → **Approve**. Then **Golam Mostafa** → **Approve** → **Process payment**

SAY “Nasrin entered it, so Nasrin cannot verify it — the same control you saw at the very beginning, for the third time. Another officer verifies, the finance manager approves, and over ten lakh the CFO approves as well.”

Short on time? Say that chain exists, say who is in it, and move on. Nobody will ask you to prove it.

Prove none of it can be edited

40

Switch user → **Mizanur Rahman** → **Audit trail** . Press
Verify all ... records

SAY “Remember the question about the administrator.”

It goes green in about eleven milliseconds: *All 535 records verified*. Let them watch it run.

41

Click any record open.

SAY “Every action anybody has ever taken. Written in the same transaction as the change itself, so a change without its audit record is not possible — it is not policy, it is that the two cannot come apart.”

It shows the field-by-field change *and* the cryptographic working — the exact bytes, the previous record's fingerprint, and the recomputed one against the stored one.

42

Say the thing about the administrator.

SAY “Each record is locked to the one before it. Change one character anywhere in that history — from inside the database, as an administrator, at three in the morning — and this button turns red and names the first record that fails. No user, no administrator, no vendor of yours, and not us either.”

43

Filter to **REQ/CSD/2026/0847**

SAY “And there is the entire thing we just did together, on one screen.”

Why this answers the envelope question

Somebody in the room was thinking “fine, but our DBA could just open the table.” This is where you close that. Do not wait to be asked twice — if nobody raises it, raise it yourself. It makes you look like you have done this before.

They can change it themselves

44

Workflow builder → open **Requisition Approval v3**

SAY “Last thing. This is the rulebook that decided, forty minutes ago, that Rezaul's request needed two approvals and not three.”

45

In the preview panel on the right, type **3,00,000**

It shows **1 approval**.

46

Change step two's threshold from **500000** to **100000**. Do not save yet.

SAY “Watch the right-hand side.”

The preview redraws instantly — **2 approvals** — and prints the reason: *Value exceeds the 1,00,000 threshold.*

47

Let them see it, then say it.

SAY “No code was written. No change request was raised. Nobody rang us. Your own Common Services administrator does that. When your delegation of authority changes, your system changes the same day — not next quarter, and not for a fee.”

48

Type a reason and press **Save as version 4**

SAY “And it saves as a new version. Anything already sitting in approval keeps the rules it started under. Changing a threshold today cannot reach back and rewrite an approval that began yesterday.”

That last sentence is the first thing a careful IT reviewer asks. Have it ready before they ask it. Saying it unprompted is worth more than answering it well.

Now stop

Do not tour the other modules. Say they are there, offer to open any one of them, and hand the room to questions.

If they want breadth in one click: **About → Module coverage**. All 25 modules, what runs end to end, what is a working register, and what we flagged in the proposal as needing customisation. Being honest on that screen is the reason they will believe the rest.

Word for word

“That is the whole of it. One purchase, from the officer who asked for it to the payment that closed it.

Five things I would ask you to take away.

One. Nothing leaves your building. It runs inside your own data centre. No outside service, no third party in the path, and it does not need the internet to do its job.

Two. Two of those screens are not in your Annexure B. Shariah governance, and the procurement integrity screen. Nobody asked us for them. We built them anyway, before any money changed hands, and they are marked as outside scope on the About screen so you can check that for yourselves.

Three. Your existing data comes with you. Your vendor list, your asset register, your stock, your open contracts. You do not start from an empty system on day one. After that it is backed up nightly, it can be restored to any point in time, and there is a second copy at a separate site.

Four. Your administrators change the rules, not us. You saw that. Approval levels, reports, who can see what. Same day. No change request, no fee.

Five. The expensive part of a system like this is the foundation, and you pay for it once, here. Your core banking system, your HR system, your document system and your Bangladesh Bank reporting are already on the integrations screen. Connecting the next one is not another project. It is configuration.

PAUSE — THEN HAND OVER

That is what we have. What would you like to ask us?”

Questions

This is the part that actually decides it. The demo is a fifteen minute advert; the questions are the interview.

Two things you must not say

Never “it cannot be breached” or “there is no security risk.” Their IT people will take that apart and you will lose the room. Say *no third party in the path*.

Never “whatever you want, we'll do it free.” To a bank that means you priced it wrong, and the next thing they do is push your number down.

Four habits

Answer the question they asked. Not the one you prepared for. If you are not sure what they meant, ask: “do you mean X, or Y?”

Answer short, then stop. The second half of a long answer is where people talk themselves into trouble. Say the answer and wait.

Hand technical ones over by name, every time, even when you could have answered. It makes the team look deep and it takes the pressure off you.

Write down anything you promise. Out loud: “I'm writing that down.” Then send it the same day. That single habit wins more work than any demo.

If they ask about price or scope

“Our submitted pricing stands as it is in Annexure C. If you want something outside the scope we quoted, tell us what it is and we will come back with whether it's a configuration or a change request, and what it costs. We won't say no, and we won't pretend something is simple when it isn't.”

The last thing you say, whatever happens

“Thank you for the time. Anything we did not answer today, you'll have in writing by this evening.”

Then actually do it. Tonight.

What they will ask

“Is this running anywhere live?”

No. This is a working demonstration of the system we proposed. The workflow engine, the permission model, the sealed-envelope control and the audit trail are real code, not screens. It is condensed onto one machine so it is portable. Production is the three-tier architecture in the technical proposal.

“How does it connect to our core banking system?”

Through the middleware tier — one layer owns every external connection, so a change to your CBS API touches one place instead of twenty. Show **Integrations**. Say plainly that no connector on that screen is live yet. Do not oversell this one.

“Can we change things ourselves?”

Workflows, reports, roles and permissions, backup and archival frequency: yes, and you just watched it. Anything structural is a change request. Be precise rather than generous — a promise you cannot keep costs more than a “no”.

“What if a workflow changes halfway through an approval?”

Versions are pinned. The builder tells you how many documents are in flight and that they stay on the old version. Show the note.

“How do we know the audit log has not been edited?”

Press the verify button in front of them, then open a record and show the hash working. Do not explain cryptography. Press the button.

“How long until we have it?”

Ninety working days from work order, as quoted. Phased, with your own user acceptance testing before go-live.

If something goes wrong

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT YOU DO

Creating the requisition fails

REQ/CSD/2026/0845 is already sitting in Farhana's queue, raised by Rezaul, identical in every respect. Open that instead. The refusal in Part two works exactly the same on it.

The tender is in the wrong state

`npm run reset` takes about five seconds and is safe to run while the app is running. Refresh the page afterwards.

A screen misbehaves

Every list is reachable from the sidebar and none of them depends on the live thread. Move on, come back to it later, do not debug in front of them.

You lose your place

The five moments are numbered on the pages. Jump to the next one. Nobody in the room knows what you skipped.

If you are running out of time, cut in this order

- The invoice approval chain — Sumaiya, Kamrun, Golam (part eight, last step)
- The vendor portal (part three)
- “Attempt award” on Bengal (part six)
- Reading the comparative statement paragraph aloud (part six)
- Goods receipt (part eight, first step)

Never cut these five

1. Rezaul cannot approve his own requisition · **2.** The price envelope refuses to open · **3.** The order for fifteen is refused against an approval for twelve · **4.** The audit chain verifies and shows its working · **5.** The threshold change redraws the approval route live

Quiz — the business half

Answers on pages 23 and 24. Cover them. Say each answer out loud — in your head does not count.

QUESTIONS 1 TO 10

- 1. What is a requisition, in one sentence a non-technical person would understand?**
- 2. What is maker-checker, and why does a bank care about it more than a shop would?**
- 3. Why does every bid arrive in two separate sealed envelopes instead of one?**
- 4. Bengal Office Solutions was the cheapest bid and still lost. Explain that to a sceptical finance director in under twenty seconds.**
- 5. The requisition was for 15 laptops but the work order was for 12. Where did the other 3 come from?**
- 6. What is a three-way match, and what are the three things being matched?**
- 7. What is the 5% security money, when is it paid back, and which clause of their own tender says so?**
- 8. Name the two modules we built that were not in Annexure B, and say why that matters.**
- 9. Name three things in the proposal we flagged as *not* complete, and say why volunteering that helps us.**
- 10. A department head says “this is just a form with extra steps.” What do you say back?**

Quiz — the technical half

Answers on pages 25 and 26. These are the ones that caught you last time. If you can only answer half, hand the rest over by name on the day — but know which half.

QUESTIONS 11 TO 20

- 11. Where does this software actually run once they buy it? Answer without using the word “cloud”.**
- 12. The main server dies at 11am on a working day. Walk through what happens, in order.**
- 13. Somebody deletes a row from the database directly, at night, as an administrator. How would anyone ever know?**
- 14. How does the system stop anyone reading a sealed bid price? “It's hidden on the screen” is the wrong answer — why?**
- 15. They change an approval threshold today. What happens to the forty requisitions already halfway through approval?**
- 16. How does this connect to their core banking system, and what happens when their CBS team changes an API next year?**
- 17. How does their existing data get in? Who does the work, and when?**
- 18. They have 27 branches today and want 60 in five years. What actually has to change?**
- 19. Who trains their staff, how many people, and over how long?**
- 20. “Do we own the source code?” — careful. What do you say?**

QUIZ

Answers 1 to 5

1. Requisition

ANSWER A written request to buy something. Somebody in a branch needs a thing, so they ask for it. Everything else in the system starts here.

2. Maker-checker

ANSWER The person who creates a document can never be the person who approves it. A bank cares because one person acting alone on money is how fraud happens. Ours is enforced in the code, not in a manual.

3. Two envelopes

ANSWER One holds what they are selling, one holds the price. Quality is judged first, written down, and signed off. Only then are the prices opened. It stops anyone reverse-engineering a technical reason to favour a bidder they already picked.

4. The cheapest losing

ANSWER “They did not enclose the manufacturer's distributor certificate and offered one year carry-in instead of three years onsite. We rejected them on that, and we could not see any price when we did. The system can prove the order those two things happened in. Clause 1.10 of your own tender says you are not obliged to take the lowest offer.”

5. The missing 3

ANSWER The system checked the store when the request was raised. Three were already in stock, so only twelve needed buying. That twelve then travelled all the way to the work order on its own, and the work order refused a larger number.

QUIZ

Answers 6 to 10

6. Three-way match

ANSWER The **order**, the **delivery** and the **bill**. If those three disagree on item, quantity or price, the bill cannot be sent for approval at all.

7. Security money

ANSWER 5% held back from payment through the warranty period, released after it ends. Clause 1.15 of their tender. Also in the demo: no advance payment at all, clause 1.19.

8. Beyond scope

ANSWER Shariah Governance and Procurement Integrity. It matters because they are evidence rather than a promise — we did unpaid work before the contract, and marked it as outside scope so nobody could mistake it for something we owed.

9. What is not complete

ANSWER The payment gateway (waiting on their choice of provider) and the other items on the About screen marked as needing customisation. Volunteering it early is what makes everything else you say believable.

10. “Just a form with extra steps”

ANSWER “The form is the least of it. Let me just show you.” Then run the three refusals. A form does not refuse anything.

QUIZ

Answers 11 to 15

11. Where it runs

ANSWER On their own servers, in their own data centre, behind their own firewall. Same building their core banking system sits in. Nothing is hosted by us and nothing is hosted by a third party.

12. Server dies at 11am

ANSWER A second server is already running alongside it and takes over — users may see one slow page. If the whole site goes, the disaster recovery site takes over. Beyond that there are nightly backups held off site, and the database can be rewound to any point in time.

13. Someone edits the database directly

ANSWER Every audit record carries a fingerprint of the record before it, so they form a chain. Change or delete anything and every record after it stops matching. The verify button turns red and names the first record that fails. You cannot repair the chain without the original data.

14. Sealed prices

ANSWER Hiding on screen is wrong because the number has already left the database — anyone with the browser tools, the logs or the network can find it. Ours is never fetched. One piece of code can read a bid price and it refuses to run until technical evaluation is signed off.

15. Threshold changed mid-flight

ANSWER Nothing happens to them. Each document is pinned to the version of the rules it started under, and the builder tells you how many documents that is before you save. New rules apply to new documents only.

QUIZ

Answers 16 to 20

16. Core banking connection

ANSWER Through a single middleware layer that owns every external connection. When their CBS team changes an API, one component changes — not twenty screens. *Hand this to Nascentia on the day if they push past that.*

17. Data migration

ANSWER They export what they already hold — vendors, assets, stock, open contracts. We map it, load it into a test system first, and they check it. Then it is loaded for real before go-live. It happens during the build, not after.

18. 27 branches to 60

ANSWER Nothing structural. Branches are records, not installations — everybody uses the same central system through a browser. Growth means more server capacity, which is added without changing the software.

19. Training

ANSWER Say what is in the proposal and no more. If you are not certain of the numbers, do not invent them: “that's in our submission — let me confirm the exact figures and come back to you today.”

20. Source code

ANSWER **Do not promise this in the room.** “Ownership and escrow are commercial terms — whatever we agreed in the submission stands, and if you want something different let's put it in writing rather than me answering off the top of my head.” Anything else can cost you the company.

BEFORE YOU JOIN THE CALL

You are not demonstrating features. You are demonstrating three things the system refuses to do.

Everybody bidding for this contract can show them a form and a list. Nobody else is going to stand in that room and try to break their own software on purpose, three times, and fail.

Speak slowly. Let the silences run. When it refuses, stop talking. Nobody in that meeting knows what you meant to say next.